Lesson 10 Sidebars

Play It Again

VIDEO GAME CREATION

These aren't part of the lesson's required work. Think of them the way a textbook sidebar works: a deeper, tangential look at something this lesson's build actually ran into - why one approach was chosen over the others, what the alternatives were, or an idea worth a longer look than the Handout has room for. Pull one out for a discussion moment if it fits, hand it to a curious student, or skip it entirely - nothing here is required reading.

The Engine Says It Can Do That - Should You Trust It?

001 Game Creator actually has a built-in "Restart Game" action. This lesson doesn't use it. That's on purpose.

While researching this lesson, a genuine built-in Restart Game action turned up in 001 Game Creator, confirmed to exist via community documentation. At first glance it looked like it would make this entire lesson's Custom Event/reset logic unnecessary. It wasn't used, for one specific reason: nowhere in the official documentation is it clearly specified exactly what state the action resets, and what it leaves alone. For a course built specifically around verified engine behavior - a standard held to deliberately, given how often this particular engine's real UI and behavior has turned out to differ from a reasonable-sounding guess - an undocumented black box wasn't something to build a lesson, or a student's actual game, around.

The choice made instead: build the reset manually and explicitly, using a Custom Event that spells out exactly what gets reset, in full view, line by line. Genuinely more setup than clicking one built-in action - but every part of it is verifiable, debuggable, and actually understood by the student who built it, rather than trusted on faith.

The general principle worth naming directly: "the engine has a button for that" is not the same question as "should I press it." A convenient-looking built-in feature is only as trustworthy as its documentation - if you can't find or confirm exactly what it does, that's a real, professional signal to consider the manual, explicit version instead, even though it costs more time up front. This isn't just a beginner-course caution; it's a genuine, everyday engineering judgment call.

- **A smaller companion example, same lesson:** GDevelop's version of "run this logic from two different places" doesn't use anything like a callable function at all - it just makes the SAME event group reachable through an "Or" condition (scene start, OR a restart flag being set). A completely different mechanism, an equally valid solution to the same underlying problem ("one place, two ways in") - a good reminder that "the same concept" doesn't have to mean "the same implementation," a theme that comes up constantly across this course's 8 engines.